

1946, December 27.

The following is a faithful transcription of the carbon copy of the typed original of the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, C.F.M. Cap.

SAINT FELIX CAPUCHIN FRIARY.
HUNTINGTON, INDIANA
December 27th. 1946

Dr. J. P. Young. 216 North Jefferson, Huntington, Indiana.

My dear Dr. Young:

God bless you and yours for a blessed Christmastide and, please God too, a happy prosperous New Year. I was sorry to learn of your not being well. I hope its nothing too serious. But whether serious or not, we may be sure that inasmuch as we take such things as from the hand of God, they will never fail in the end to turnout as having been a blessing in disguise. At all events I am enrolling you in the Seraphic Mass Association and am praying for your speedy recovery and thereafter speedy improvement, - physically of course and, what is infinitely of more importance, spiritually.

God knows that, in our stupidity we all need real conversion to Him. Anyhow, I hope things brighten for you soon in both regards. No question about it, if we do the right thing on our part God never fails us. Just here, however is always a danger. We are naturally so inclined to go wrong. Therefore too, our obligation to admonish one another when danger threatens.

Hence, Dear Doctor Young: I feel that I would not be your friend or even a decently grateful patient were I to be silent as to dangers ahead of you as I see them without any doubt.

Only yesterday a middle-aged couple - friends of yours too - lamented to me that after several years in holy matrimony, they had never been blessed with - what I have long since considered the greatest blessing that, in the natural order, God gives on earth, A Family. And my Doctor Young has no family. ? Because the family that God blessed him with has no head. ? At all events, it is a sad situation; and notwithstanding the fearful prevalence of similar cases, it must be, in the sight of Heaven a most lamentable problem.

Not since yesterday only Doctor, has this been on my mind; but since away back in July, and decidedly more so since early in September; when a youth came into your office while I was waiting in one of the apartments and whom, judging from his voice and the familiarity that followed between you, I took to be a son of yours of probably fifteen to seventeen years. He seemed promisingly bright and alert; but what pained me as the little dialogue proceeded was the sad want of filial reverence and even respect shown to his father. So much so, in fact that I almost called out to him: "Boy ... Honor thy father and thy mother". "Alas", I thought afterwards, "The poor lad has only an absentee father and his mother a convert Where is the responsibility? Who's to blame?"